LMB

LMBCONSULTANTS.COM

EXECUTIVE BUSINESS PLAN OUTLINE

DISDAIN ENERGY

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CONTENTS PAGE

Contents Page 1

1. Executive summary 2

2. Mission 4

3. Vision 4

4. Motivation 5

5. Company overview 5

    5.1. Legal Structure & Ownership 6

    5.2. ADVISORS 7

    5.3. OPERATIONAL STRUCTURE 7

    5.4. REGULATORY COMPLIANCE 8

    5.5. Business Objectives 8

6. Market Analysis 9

    6.1 Market Overview 10

    6.2 Target Market 10

    6.3 Customer Overview 11

    6.4 SWOT Analysis 12

7. Competitive Edge 14

7.1 Competitive Advantage 14

8. Operational Plan 15

9. Marketing Plan 17

    9.1. DIGITAL MARKETING 18

    9.2. TRADITIONAL MARKETING 18

    9.3. PROMOTION STRATEGY 19

    9.4 SALES STRATEGY 19

10. Business Model 20

    10.1 Distribution Channels 20

11. Management Structure 21

12. Financial Projections 22

12.1 Profit and loss statement 22
12.2 cash flow (average scenario) 23
12.3 Cash flow (positive scenario) 23
12.4 cash flow (negative scenario) 24
12.5 Financial Trends and forecasts 24
12.6 Workings 28
Label Costs 29
Enterprise Ireland Grant 29
Initial Stock Investment 29
Website Expenses 29
13. Resources 29
13.1 Production Resources 30
13.2 Storage and Sales Resources 30
13.3 People and Support Resources 31
14. Risk Assessment 31
14.1 Primary Risks 31
14.2 Mitigation Strategies 33
15. Letter of Support 34
16. Food Safety Declaration 35
15. References 36

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

DISDAIN Ltd is an Irish energy drink company founded in January 2026. Our mission is to deliver a powerful caffeine boost that enhances productivity during work, study, and late-night efforts — all while offering a distinctive flavor that stands out in the market.

At DISDAIN, we believe companies should be transparent and honest with consumers. We are committed to avoiding misleading marketing practices and harmful ingredients, ensuring our customers fully understand what they consume and can trust our brand.

Production has begun with a small, dedicated team, and our product is currently distributed locally through independent shops and vending machines. We are seeking €100,000 in funding to expand operations and advertising across Ireland.

This investment will be used to:

- Build a strong social media presence
- Hire developers to create a professional website
- Employ marketing specialists to drive traffic and promote upcoming products and vouchers

Our primary target market is college students aged 17–25 who need convenient, affordable energy support for busy academic and social lives.

DISDAIN products will emphasize full transparency by clearly listing ingredients and quantities. Our retail price will be €2 per unit, positioning us competitively below higher-priced alternatives while maintaining quality and trust.

2. MISSION

At LMB, we are building more than just another energy drink. Under our new line, Disdain, our goal is to create a bold, honest alternative in a market dominated by oversized corporations and artificial formulas. Disdain is designed for people who genuinely rely on caffeine to push through work, college, creative projects, and long nights. Our mission is simple: deliver real energy without unnecessary complications.

Our first product will be a cola-flavored energy drink, bridging the gap between traditional cola brands and modern energy drinks. While major companies dominate both markets, few offer a familiar cola flavor combined with functional energy. Disdain stands out by pairing a flavor people already trust with the boost they actually need.

Transparency is at the core of our product. Rather than marketing ourselves as artificially "healthy," we aim to be honest. Energy drinks are not health products — they are functional beverages — but we believe they can be made better. Our formula will prioritize simple, recognizable ingredients, using real sugar instead of artificial alternatives like aspartame or high-fructose corn syrup, and caffeine derived from natural sources such as Secura seeds, ensuring consumers know exactly what they are drinking. No hidden formulas. No misleading claims. Just a reliable energy boost.

As LMB grows, our ambition is to establish Disdain as a staple energy drink for young adults aged 18–28, particularly within urban, creative, and gaming communities. By building a brand that feels authentic and rooted in real consumer experience — not corporate boardrooms — we aim to compete on both quality and price, positioning Disdain as a strong, credible alternative in an oversaturated market. Through clear branding, honest communication, and a focused product identity, LMB intends to carve out a lasting presence in the energy drink industry.

3. VISION

Our vision at LMB is to make Disdain a recognized staple in the energy drink market — a brand that represents honesty, simplicity, and a new generation of consumers. By prioritizing straightforward ingredients and avoiding unnecessary chemical additives, we aim to give consumers peace of mind. Instead of second-guessing what they're drinking, they can trust that Disdain delivers a reliable energy boost without hidden surprises or misleading claims.

As we grow, we plan to expand the Disdain line, scale distribution, and build strong connections within gaming, creative, and urban communities. Long term, our goal is to establish Disdain as a trusted, widely available brand that competes confidently with major players — while staying true to its core promise of transparency, authenticity, and stress-free energy.

4. MOTIVATION

There are currently many energy drinks on the market, but many of them fall short for two main reasons: poor taste and health concerns. Although many brands advertise themselves as "healthy," they often do not adhere to this image and are instead filled with artificial chemicals.

This problem is not limited to one brand. Companies such as Monster Energy dominate the energy drink market, while Coca-Cola and Pepsi dominate the cola market. However, there is a noticeable gap for a product that combines a familiar taste with a more honest and simplified approach.

While an energy drink cannot realistically be considered "healthy," our goal is to create a healthier and more honest energy drink compared to existing options. We're aiming to keep ingredients simple and transparent, avoiding unnecessary chemical additives and instead using safer, more familiar ingredients — for example, using sugar instead of high-fructose corn syrup. This approach also reduces stress for consumers. Many modern products are overly complicated, and understanding their ingredients and long-term effects can be tiring. Our aim is to create a drink where consumers know exactly what they are getting: a nice energy boost that doesn't have hidden downsides.

5. COMPANY OVERVIEW

Disdain is an Irish beverage start-up focused on developing a new energy drink built around taste, transparency, and simplicity. Established in 2026, the company aims to challenge both traditional soft drink brands and established energy drink companies by offering a product that provides a dependable energy boost without relying on unnecessary additives or misleading health claims.

The company's first product is a cola-flavored energy drink, combining the familiar taste of classic cola with the functional benefits of an energy drink. This positions Disdain within the same general market as major brands such as Coca-Cola and Pepsi, while also competing with energy drink companies like Monster Energy. However, unlike many competitors, Disdain aims to provide a more straightforward and honest alternative for consumers.

5.1. Legal Structure & Ownership

LMB Consultants is a private limited company registered with the Companies Registration Office (CRO) under LMB Consultants Ltd located at Terry Rd, Athlone, Co. Westmeath, Ireland, N21RK99. The company was founded by:

- Benjamin Mills
- Michael Doherty
- Liam Moore

Each founder holds an equal share (33.3%) in the company, and each brings extensive education and experience in software development. The founders will manage all core business operations, including product development, branding, marketing, and distribution planning.

In the initial stages, the founders plan to operate on a part-time basis and will not take a salary during the first year, allowing profits to be reinvested into product development, marketing, and business growth.

5.2. ADVISORS

Disdain has sought guidance from individuals with relevant experience in the food and beverage industry, branding, and distribution. These advisors provide informal support in key areas such as:

- Product refining
- Branding and marketing strategy
- Retail trends and consumer behavior
- Supply chain and distribution logistics

Advisory support is provided on a pro-bono basis during the initial stages of the business, demonstrating confidence in the concept and a willingness to support emerging Irish start-ups.

5.3. OPERATIONAL STRUCTURE

The development of the Disdain brand, including product design, flavor creation, and marketing strategy, will be managed in-house by the founders. This ensures full control over the product's identity and direction.

The manufacturing process will be outsourced to a third-party beverage production company based in Ireland (Bev Craft). This partner will handle large-scale production, bottling/canning, distribution, and quality control to ensure the product meets industry standards.

Benefits of Outsourcing Production:

- Reduce upfront investment in machinery, facilities, and specialized equipment
- Benefit from existing supplier networks for ingredients and packaging
- Ensure consistent product quality through experienced manufacturers

Distribution will initially be handled through, retail and wholesale channels with plans to expand into direct-to-consumer online sales of retail and wholesale channels over time and eventually begin distribution on different continents.

5.4. REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

As a beverage company operating in Ireland and the EU, Disdain Ltd must comply with all relevant food safety, labeling and consumer protection regulations, including:

• Food Safety Authority of Ireland (FSAI) guidelines
• Food Information to Consumers Regulation (EU) No.1169/2011 which governs labelling requirements, including ingredients, allergens, and nutritional information
• EU Food Safety Regulations relating to caffeine content and labelling requirements for energy drinks
• General Food Law Regulation (EC) No. 178/2002 which establishes core principles of food safety and traceability
• HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points) standards for food production standards for identifying and controlling food safety risks
Regulation (EC) No. 852/2004 on the hygiene of foodstuffs, ensuring proper food safety practices during production

All ingredients will be sourced from approved and certified suppliers, ensuring compliance with safety and quality standards.

5.5. Business Objectives

Disdain Ltd aims to establish itself as a credible and competitive brand within the energy drink and soft drink market that supports sustainable and realistic expansion through the following objectives:

SHORT-TERM (1-2 YEARS)

• Product development and launch with manufacturing of 100000 initial units in our first year to maintain adequate inventory levels.
• Launch our website with direct-to-consumer sales to maximize profits.
• Build brand awareness through targeted marketing campaigns
• Achieve initial sales targets and develop a loyal customer base.
• Maintain competitive pricing to attract early adopters.

MEDIUM-TERM (3-5 YEARS)

• Increase unit sales year-on-year through expansion of distribution channels.

• Reduce marketing expenditure slightly due to growing word of mouth and positive Customer reviews.

• Introduce new flavors or variations based on customer feedback.

• Establish additional partnerships with retailers, convenience stores, and supermarkets across Ireland and abroad.

LONG-TERM (5-10 YEARS)

• Continuous improvement and development based on customer feedback.

• Expand into international markets, particularly within Europe.

• Continue product innovation while maintaining brand values of honesty and simplicity

• Establish Disdain as a recognized brand within the beverage market

• Build strong relationships with retailers and distributors to secure long-term growth

6. MARKET ANALYSIS

The energy drink market has grown considerably in recent years, driven by rising demand for convenient energy sources, changing consumer habits, and busy lifestyles. According to Grandview research, “The global energy drinks market size was estimated at USD 79.39 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach USD 125.11 billion by 2030.”

In Europe, the market is also growing due to rising consumption among young adults, students, and workers. Energy drinks have become a common part of daily routines, particularly for those seeking improved focus, performance, and alertness.

There are several key factors that contribute to market expansion:

- Rising awareness of ingredients – Consumers are becoming more conscious of what they consume and are seeking more honest transparent products.
- Growth in young adult consumption – Energy drinks are highly sought-after with people aged 18–32.
- Rising demand for convenience – Consumers requires fast and simple energy boosts for busy lifestyles.

- Expansion of lifestyle branding – There are lots of energy drink brands connected to gaming, sports, and youth culture.

Despite this growth, there are clear gaps in the market. Many energy drinks are criticized for their artificial taste and complex/confusing ingredient lists, which can reduce consumer trust and comfort. Additionally, while soft drinks like cola are popular for their flavor, they do not provide the same energy benefits and are also victim to overcomplicating ingredients.

Our product is positioned to take advantage of these trends by offering a cola-flavored energy drink that combines:

- Greater ingredient transparency
- Familiar and enjoyable taste
- Energy-boosting functionality
- Honest and straightforward branding

Using this, our product offers an alternative to both traditional energy drinks and soft drinks. This allows us to stand out in a competitive market while appealing to consumers who want a balance between taste, energy, and trust.

6.1 Market Overview

In the energy drink market, we would be entering strong competition. In Ireland, there are several companies that offer energy drinks, however, many of them are similar in terms of flavor, ingredients and branding, and do not fully meet all consumer expectations. Brands such as **Monster Beverage**, **Red Bull GmbH** and **Lucozade** dominate the market, but their products are often criticized for artificial taste and lack of transparency in ingredients.

Some energy drinks are available in supermarkets and convenience stores, but most are very similar and focus on strong flavors and high caffeine. Customers can also buy drinks like **Prime**, however some of these have been criticized for their ingredients and marketing. Many products also rely heavily on branding and are often expensive.

Most energy drinks use artificial flavoring and complex formulas, which may not appeal to consumers who prefer simpler products. At the same time, cola drinks from companies such as **Coca-Cola Company** and **PepsiCo** taste good but do not provide energy.

6.2 Target Market

➔ Young Adults (18–28)
This group is one of the largest consumers of energy drinks, often using them for work, study, and social activities.

➔ Gamers and Digital Users
Gaming culture has strong links to energy drink consumption, with many brands already targeting this audience. Our direct involvement in this space allows for authentic marketing.

➔ Students and Workers
Students and working individuals often rely on caffeine for focus and productivity, making them a key target group.

➔ Active Lifestyle Consumers
Individuals involved in sports or physical activities may seek a convenient energy boost combined with a familiar taste.

➔ Consumers Seeking Simplicity and Transparency
A growing segment of consumers prefer products with clear ingredients and honest branding, which aligns directly with our product's positioning.

6.3 Customer Overview

Our product is designed to appeal to a wide range of consumers who are looking for a reliable, enjoyable, and transparent energy drink. While the primary focus is on young adults, gamers, students, and active individuals, the product also appeals to soft drink consumers who may not typically choose energy drinks due to taste or ingredient concerns.

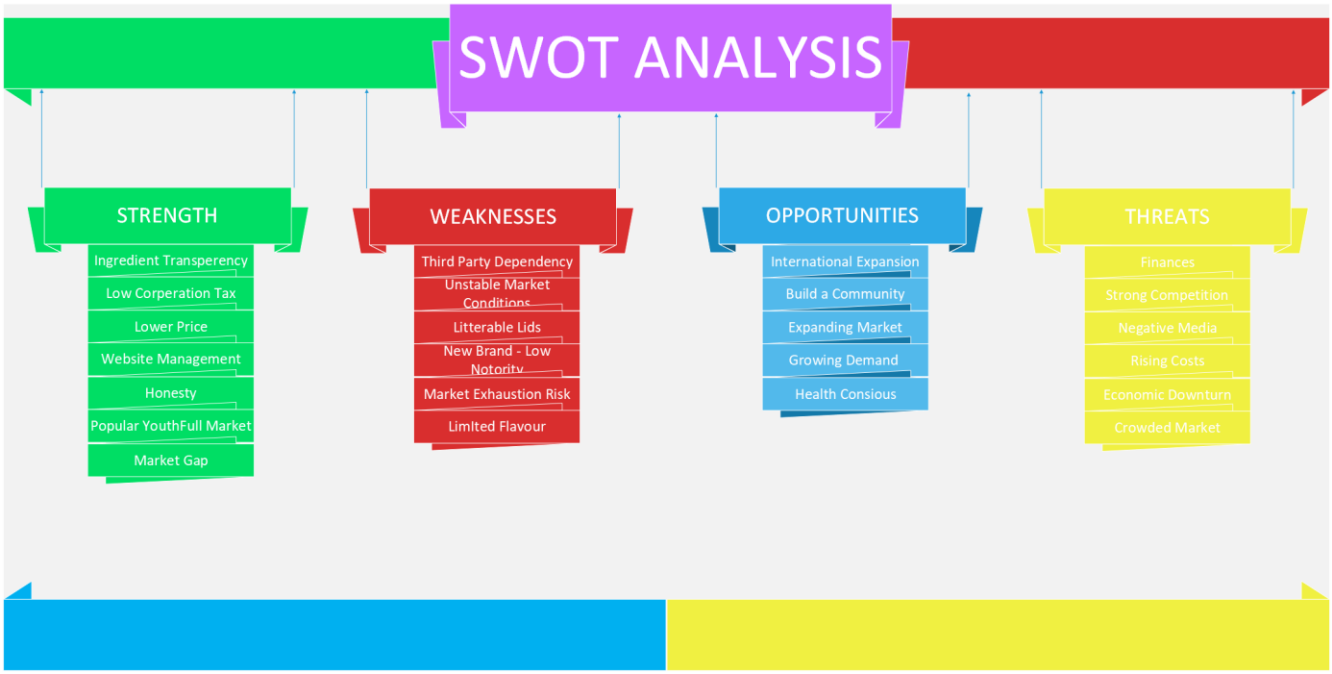
The use of a cola flavour makes the product more accessible and familiar, lowering the barrier for new customers entering the energy drink category.

A key strength of the product is its focus on honesty and transparency, which helps build trust with consumers. By clearly communicating ingredients and avoiding misleading health claims, the brand can create a stronger and more authentic relationship with its audience.

As the business grows, opportunities exist to expand into:

- Additional flavors
- Sugar-free or alternative versions
- Wider geographic markets

This flexibility supports long-term growth while maintaining a consistent brand identity.


SWOT ANALYSIS
STRENGTH
Ingredient Transperency
Low Corperation Tax
Lower Price
Website Management
Honesty
Popular YouthFull Market
Market Gap
WEAKNESSES
Third Party Dependency
Unstable Market Conditions
Litterable Lids
New Brand - Low Notority
Market Exhaustion Risk
Limlted Flavour
OPPORTUNITIES
International Expansion
Build a Community
Expanding Market
Growing Demand
Health Consious
THREATS
Finances
Strong Competition
Negative Media
Rising Costs
Economic Downturn
Crowded Market

6.4 SWOT Analysis

Strengths

- Ingredient transparency and honest branding
- Unique cola-flavored energy drink (market gap)
- Lower price potential than major brands
- Strong connection to Popular Youthful Market target audience (gamers, students)
- Simple and easy-to-understand product (less stressful choice)
- Low corporation Tax established in Ireland which benefits from low corporation tax
- Website Management a well-maintained website or any queries

Weaknesses

- Third Party Dependency Currently reliant on third party company (bevcraft however they are a strong business with no signs of shutting down)
- Unstable Market Conditions
- Litter able lids
- New brand with low notoriety
- Market Exhaustion Risk
- Limited budget compared to major competitors
- Limited product range (single flavor at launch)

Opportunities

- International Expansion
- Build a strong community and brand identity
- Expanding market
- Growing demand for transparent and honest products
- Health conscious
- Social media and influencer marketing opportunities

Threats

- Finances
- Strong competition from global brands (Coke, Pepsi, Monster)
- Negative perceptions of energy drinks
- Rising production and distribution costs

- Economic downturn
- Crowded market with many alternatives

7. COMPETITIVE EDGE

Our goal is to provide an affordable product that is transparent about its ingredients, delivers consistent quality, and is produced through ethical practices.

7.1 COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

Unlike existing products, Disdain provides a unique combination of:

- **Can Design**
  Our packaging is visually appealing and functional, helping the product stand out on shelves while enhancing the overall customer experience.

- **Affordable**
  We offer a competitively priced product, making it accessible without compromising on quality.

- **Quality Ingredients**
  We use high-quality ingredients to ensure a reliable and satisfying product every time.

- **Gain Coupons for Recycling**
  We encourage customers to return or reuse packaging through a coupon system, promoting sustainability while rewarding loyalty.

- **Ethical Practices**
  Our product is made using ethical sourcing and production methods, appealing to socially conscious consumers

8. OPERATIONAL PLAN

DISDAIN Ltd.'s operational strategy is designed to ensure efficient product development, manufacturing, distribution, and brand growth while maintaining high standards of quality, transparency, and customer satisfaction. Our operations are divided into key areas: product development, manufacturing and supply chain, distribution and logistics, customer support, and regulatory compliance.

➔ Product Development

DISDAIN Ltd develops its energy drink recipes in-house, focusing on a distinctive flavor profile and effective caffeine content to support productivity. Formulations are tested to balance taste, performance, and safety. Customer feedback from students and early adopters will guide future improvements and new flavor variations. Packaging design and branding are also developed internally to reflect the company's commitment to honesty and transparency.

➔ Manufacturing and Supply Chain

Production is initially carried out in partnership with a licensed beverage manufacturer in Ireland to ensure compliance with food safety standards and to support scalable output. Key ingredients — including caffeine, flavorings, sweeteners, and carbonated water — are sourced from certified suppliers that meet EU food safety regulations.
Quality control checks are conducted on each batch to ensure consistency, taste, and safety. Finished products are stored in a small, rented storage facility to manage inventory efficiently before distribution to retailers and vending partners.

➔ Distribution and Logistics

Our primary distribution channels are local independent shops, college-area retailers, and vending machines in high-traffic locations such as campuses and transport hubs. As operations expand, DISDAIN plans to supply larger retail chains across Ireland.
Deliveries to retail partners are handled through contracted local logistics providers to ensure timely restocking. Inventory levels are reviewed regularly to prevent shortages and support demand during peak academic periods.

➔ Customer Support

Customer inquiries, feedback, and business partnership requests will be handled via email and social media platforms. This allows customers to ask questions about ingredients, report issues, or suggest new flavors.
Our commitment to transparency includes publicly available product information,

ingredient breakdowns, and updates on upcoming releases and promotions through our website and social channels.

➔ Regulatory Compliance

DISDAIN adheres to all relevant food and beverage regulations, including:

- EU and Irish food safety standards for beverage production
- Accurate ingredient labeling and caffeine content disclosure
- Health and safety regulations for manufacturing and distribution
- Environmental guidelines for packaging and recycling

9. MARKETING PLAN

Disdain will target the Irish beverage market, competing with major brands such as Coca-Cola, Pepsi, and Monster Energy. To enter this market, Disdain will initially focus on **smaller, local retail outlets**, including independent shops, convenience stores, and student-focused locations. Using in-store promotions and sampling to gather customer feedback and build an early customer base.

Once demand becomes more consistent, we will expand distribution into **larger retail chains and supermarkets**. Additionally, As the business grows and demand increases, the company plans to expand into **direct-to-consumer online sales** to further increase accessibility and customer engagement.

In today's digital environment, social media plays a key role in influencing consumer behavior, especially among young adults. Disdain will collaborate with influencers on platforms like Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube, particularly in gaming, fitness, and lifestyle content, using free samples in exchange for honest reviews to build awareness and authenticity.

The company will also develop its own social media presence, sharing content that highlights the product's flavor, ingredients, and brand identity through short videos and product demonstrations.

To further increase brand awareness, Disdain will run promotional campaigns such as discounts, bundle offers, and limited-time releases to encourage trial purchases and attract new customers.

By combining local retail partnerships, strong online presence, and targeted digital marketing, Disdain aims to build a recognizable and trusted brand within the Irish beverage market.

9.1. DIGITAL MARKETING

➔ Social Media Partnerships

Collaborate with influencers (gaming, lifestyle) on platforms like Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube to showcase real-life product use and reviews.

- Partner with gaming streamers to promote the drink during live sessions
- Send free samples to small influencers for authentic reviews
- Sponsor content creators for branded posts and short-form videos
- Collaborate with student influencers for campus-focused promotion
- Use discount codes to track influencer performance

➔ Content Marketing

Create engaging content that highlights the product's benefits, flavor, transparency and its connection to a youthful market.

- Short videos showing taste tests and comparisons
- Behind-the-scenes content on ingredients and production
- Honest breakdowns of ingredients
- Videos of different consumers giving their opinion

➔ Online Advertising

Optimize online visibility and use paid ads to reach the target audience.

- Optimize website for keywords like "energy drink"
- Use YouTube and TikTok ads targeting 18–28 age group
- Retarget website visitors with follow-up ads
- Promotion codes online that give discount in certain stores

9.2. TRADITIONAL MARKETING

➔ Events & Public Exposure

Promote the product through physical presence and real-world engagement.

- Attend student events
- Sponsor local gaming tournaments or esports events
- Set up sampling stands in shopping centers

- Promote at music festivals skate competitions or other youth-focused events
- Organize pop-up stands in busy urban areas

➔ Retail & Store Promotion

Use physical stores to increase visibility and trust.

- In-store sampling in convenience shops
- Eye-catching product displays near tills
- Promotional posters and branding in stores
- Bundle deals (e.g., buy 2 get 1 free)
- Collaboration with local shops for exclusive offers

9.3. PROMOTION STRATEGY

➔ Giveaways & Engagement

- Social media giveaways (like, share, follow)
- Competitions with prizes (gaming gear, vouchers, etc.)
- Random prizes included in orders

➔ Seasonal & Limited-Time Promotions

- Discounts during events like Black Friday or back-to-college season
- Limited-edition flavors for special occasions
- Summer promotions targeting indoor and outdoor activities
- Exam season promotions for students
- Holiday-themed packaging or offers

9.4 SALES STRATEGY

The sales strategy for Disdain is to develop brand awareness and trust with consumers, encouraging them to try the product and turn initial interest into repeat purchases. The goal is to develop a sustainable, long-term business by offering a reliable and consistent product that meets customer expectations.
While energy drinks do not require traditional after-sales service, Disdain will focus on customer support and engagement to strengthen trust.
To encourage repeat purchases, Disdain will focus on maintaining consistent quality, taste, and clear ingredient transparency. The company will also continue to

improve the product based on customer feedback, including potential adjustments to flavor or the introduction of new variations.
Providing ongoing communication and support shows a strong commitment to customer satisfaction and respect, helping customers feel confident in the product. This approach will help Disdain build long-term loyalty and steady growth within the competitive beverage market.

10. BUSINESS MODEL

Business Model

Our company will follow a **direct sales model**, generating revenue through the sale of our product while prioritizing affordability, transparency, and quality. Unlike premium competitors, we focus on delivering strong value for money, making our product accessible to a wider market.

Revenue Streams

1. Direct Product Sales (Primary)

- Retail price: € 4 (assuming 4 pack)
- Manufacturing cost: €2.31
- Gross margin: 42.25%

2. Retail & Distribution Partnerships

- Partner with retailers (e.g. supermarkets, convenience stores) to expand our reach.
- Products will be stocked in high-visibility areas to increase impulse purchases.
- Retail partnerships increase brand awareness and sales volume.

3. Coupon Recycling Initiative

- Customers receive discounts or rewards for returning/recycling cans.
- Encourage repeat purchases and build customer loyalty.
- Supports sustainability while also increasing long-term revenue.

4. Bulk & Promotional Sales

- Discounts offered on multi-pack purchases to encourage higher volume buying.
- Limited-time promotions to attract new customers and boost sales.

10.1 Distribution Channels

1. Direct-to-Consumer (Primary)

- Sales through our website and social media platforms.
- Allows full control over pricing, branding, and customer relationships.

2. *Retail Stores*

- Placement in supermarkets, local shops, and convenience stores.
- Attractive design helps the product stand out on shelves.

3. *Online Marketplaces*

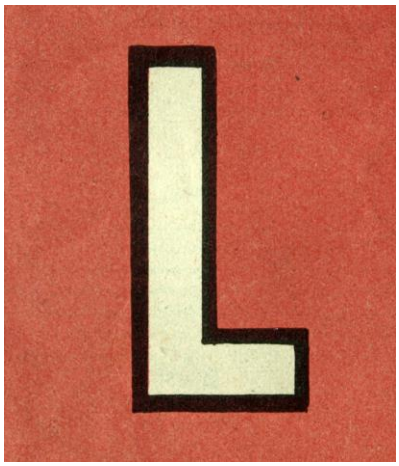
- Sell through platforms such as Amazon and eBay to reach a wider audience.
- Increases accessibility and convenience for customers.

4. *Events & Promotions*

- Sell at local events, pop-ups, and markets to build brand awareness.
- Opportunity to engage directly with customers and build your community.

11. MANAGEMENT STRUCTURE

LMB Consultants is a privately held LLC, founded by a team of financial strategists and regulatory experts. The leadership team includes:



Management Team & Structure

Disdain is managed collectively by its founders:

- Benjamin Mills

- Michael Doherty
- Liam Moore

All major decisions, including **product development, branding, marketing, and operations**, are made collaboratively. Each member contributes equally to the planning and execution of the business, ensuring a balanced and unified approach.

While individual members may take the lead on certain tasks depending on their strengths, the overall structure remains **team-based**, with shared responsibility across all areas of the business. This approach allows for greater flexibility, stronger decision-making, and a consistent vision for the company.

External Advisors & Support

Disdain is supported by a network of advisors who provide **guidance and feedback during the early stages** of the business.

- **Product & Industry Advisors** – Provide input on flavor development
- **Marketing Advisors** – Offer guidance on branding and promotional strategies
- **Distribution Advisors** – Assist with logistics and supply chain planning

These advisors offer their support on a **pro-bono basis**, helping guide the business while all key decisions and operations remain managed by the founders.

12. FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

12.1 Profit and loss statement

Other Details	
Tax Rate %	12.5
Interest Rate %	5
Total Loan Repayment	€25,900.91
Unit Cost	€150.00
Manufacture Cost	€25

Years	Sales Growth %
1-2	27%
3-4	20%
5	15%
6-10	13.5%

Year		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Units Sold		300	381	457	549	631	716	813	923	1047	1188
Income From Sales		€45,000	€57,150	€68,580	€82,296	€94,640	€107,417	€121,918	€138,377	€157,058	€178,261
Cost of Sales		€7,500	€9,525	€11,430	€13,716	€15,773	€17,903	€20,320	€23,063	€26,176	€29,710
Gross Profit		€37,500	€47,625	€57,150	€68,580	€78,867	€89,514	€101,598	€115,314	€130,882	€148,551
Selling & Distribution		€0	€0	€0	€0	€6,180	€6,180	€6,180	€6,180	€6,180	€6,180
Website Maintenance		€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158
Advertising		€6,375	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€2,500	€1,500	€1,500
Operating Activities		€7,533	€5,708	€5,708	€3,658	€11,888	€11,888	€9,838	€9,838	€8,838	€8,838
Loan Left	€20,000	€18,410	€16,740	€14,987	€13,147	€11,214	€9,184	€7,053	€4,816	€2,467	€0
Interest on Loan		€1,000	€920	€837	€749	€657	€561	€459	€353	€241	€123
Loan Repayments		€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590
Profit Before Tax		€4,943	€3,118	€3,118	€1,068	€9,298	€9,298	€7,248	€7,248	€6,248	€6,248
Profit After Tax		€4,325	€2,962	€3,113	€1,068	€9,298	€9,298	€7,248	€7,248	€6,248	€6,248
Cumulaitive		€4,325	€7,443	€10,561	€11,629	€20,927	€30,225	€37,472	€44,720	€50,968	€57,216
KPI %											
Cost of Sales %		16.67%	16.67%	16.67%	16.67%	16.67%	16.67%	16.67%	16.67%	16.67%	16.67%
Gross Profit %		83.33%	83.33%	83.33%	83.33%	83.33%	83.33%	83.33%	83.33%	83.33%	83.33%
Selling & Distribution %		0%	0%	0%	0%	6.53%	5.75%	5.07%	4.47%	3.93%	3.47%
Advertising %		14.17%	7.96%	6.63%	3.04%	4.81%	4.24%	2.05%	1.81%	0.96%	0.84%
Operating Activities %		16.74%	9.99%	8.32%	4.44%	12.56%	11.07%	8.07%	7.11%	5.63%	4.96%

12.2 cash flow (average scenario)

Year		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
CE Certificate Investment		€7,000									
Manufacture Investment Cost		€78,750									
Website Maintenance		€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158
Advertising and Marketing		€6,375	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€2,500	€1,500	€1,500
Rent (Year 5+)		€0	€0	€0	€0	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600
Utilities (Year 5+)		€0	€0	€0	€0	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580
Salaries (Year 2+)		€0	€45,000	€51,000	€51,000	€60,000	€60,000	€60,000	€60,000	€90,000	€90,000
Operational Costs		€7,533	€50,708	€56,708	€54,658	€71,888	€71,888	€69,838	€69,838	€98,838	€98,838
Enterprise Ireland Grant	€100,000	€103,000	€106,090	€109,273	€112,551	€115,927	€118,731	€120,944	€122,545	€123,528	€123,862
Grant Intereset	3%	€3,000	€3,090	€3,183	€3,278	€3,377	€2,803	€2,213	€1,605	€979	€334
Grant Repayment (Year 5+)		€0	€0	€0	€0	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€11,467
Loan	€20,000										
Loan Interes	5%	€1,000	€920	€837	€749	€657	€561	€459	€353	€241	€123
Loan Repayment		€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590
Sales Revenue		€45,000	€57,150	€68,580	€82,296	€94,640	€107,417	€121,918	€138,377	€157,058	€178,261
Cost of Sales		€7,500	€9,525	€11,430	€13,716	€15,773	€17,903	€20,320	€23,063	€26,176	€29,710
Gross Profit		€37,500	€47,625	€57,150	€68,580	€78,867	€89,514	€101,598	€115,314	€130,882	€148,551
Overall Operation Expenses		€95,873	€53,298	€59,298	€57,248	€96,957	€96,957	€94,907	€94,907	€123,907	€112,895
Net Profit Before Tax		-€58,373	-€5,673	-€2,148	€11,332	-€18,090	-€7,443	€6,691	€20,407	€6,975	€35,655
Tax	12.5%	-€7,297	-€709	-€269	€1,416	-€2,261	-€930	€836	€2,551	€872	€4,457
Cash Flow (Net Profit After Tax)		-€51,076	-€4,964	-€1,880	€9,915	-€15,829	-€6,513	€5,855	€17,856	€6,103	€31,198
Discount Rate	5%										
DCF Factor		0.9524	0.9070	0.8638	0.8227	0.7835	0.7462	0.7107	0.6768	0.6446	0.6139
NPV		-€48,644	-€4,502	-€1,624	€8,157	-€12,402	-€4,860	€4,161	€12,086	€3,934	€19,153
Cumulative NPV		-€48,644	-€53,147	-€54,770	-€46,613	-€59,015	-€63,875	-€59,714	-€47,628	-€43,694	-€24,541

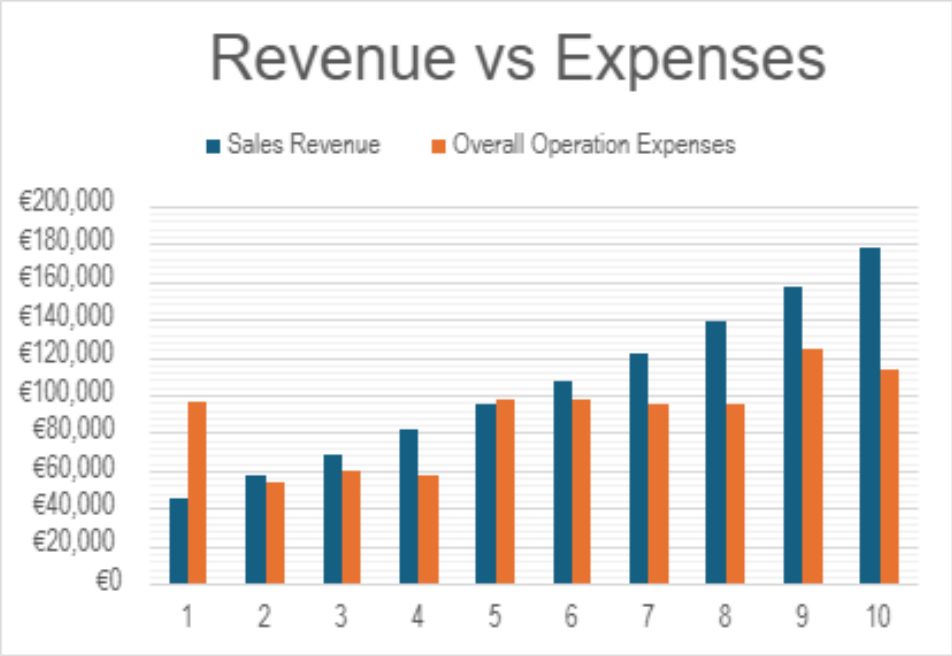
12.3 Cash flow (positive scenario)

Year		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
CE Certificate Investment		€7,000									
Manufacture Investment Cost		€78,750									
Website Maintenance		€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158
Advertising and Marketing		€8,375	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€2,500	€1,500	€1,500
Rent (Year 5+)		€0	€0	€0	€0	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600
Utilities (Year 5+)		€0	€0	€0	€0	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580
Salaries (Year 2+)		€0	€45,000	€51,000	€51,000	€80,000	€80,000	€80,000	€80,000	€90,000	€90,000
Operational Costs		€7,533	€50,708	€56,708	€54,658	€71,888	€71,888	€69,838	€69,838	€98,838	€98,838
Enterprise Ireland Grant	€100,000	€103,000	€106,090	€109,273	€112,551	€115,927	€119,391	€122,952	€126,611	€130,369	€134,230
Grant Interest	3%	€3,000	€3,090	€3,183	€3,278	€3,377	€2,803	€2,213	€1,605	€979	€334
Grant Repayment (Year 5+)		€0	€0	€0	€0	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€11,467
Loan	€20,000										
Loan Interes	5%	€1,000	€920	€837	€749	€657	€561	€459	€353	€241	€123
Loan Repayment		€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590
Sales Revenue		€45,000	€57,150	€68,580	€82,296	€94,640	€107,417	€121,918	€138,377	€157,058	€178,261
Cost of Sales		€7,500	€9,525	€11,430	€13,716	€15,773	€17,903	€20,320	€23,063	€26,176	€29,710
Gross Profit		€37,500	€47,625	€57,150	€68,580	€78,867	€89,514	€101,598	€115,314	€130,882	€148,551
Overall Operation Expenses		€96,873	€53,298	€59,298	€57,248	€96,957	€96,957	€94,907	€94,907	€123,907	€112,895
Net Profit Before Tax		-€58,373	-€5,673	-€2,148	€11,332	-€18,090	-€7,443	€6,691	€20,407	€6,975	€35,655
Tax	12.5%	-€7,297	-€709	-€269	€1,416	-€2,261	-€930	€836	€2,551	€872	€4,457
Cash Flow (Net Profit After Tax)		-€51,076	-€4,964	-€1,880	€9,915	-€15,829	-€6,513	€5,855	€17,856	€6,103	€31,198
Discount Rate	2%										
DCF Factor		0.9804	0.9612	0.9423	0.9238	0.9057	0.8880	0.8706	0.8535	0.8368	0.8203
NPV		-€50,075	-€4,771	-€1,771	€9,160	-€14,337	-€5,783	€5,097	€15,240	€5,107	€25,594
Cumulative NPV		-€50,075	-€54,846	-€56,617	-€47,457	-€61,794	-€67,577	-€62,480	-€47,240	-€42,133	-€16,539

12.4 cash flow (negative scenario)

Year		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Units Sold		250	318	407	517	657	835	1061	1349	1714	2179
CE Certificate Investment		€7,000									
Manufacture Investment Cost		€78,750									
Website Maintenance		€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158	€1,158
Advertising and Marketing		€8,375	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€4,550	€4,550	€2,500	€2,500	€1,500	€1,500
Rent (Year 5+)		€0	€0	€0	€0	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600	€3,600
Utilities (Year 5+)						€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580	€2,580
Salaries (Year 2+)		€0	€45,000	€51,000	€51,000	€80,000	€80,000	€80,000	€80,000	€90,000	€90,000
Operational Costs		€7,533	€50,708	€56,708	€54,658	€71,888	€71,888	€69,838	€69,838	€98,838	€98,838
Enterprise Ireland Grant	€100,000	€103,000	€106,090	€109,273	€112,551	€115,927					
Grant Interest	3%	€3,000	€3,090	€3,183	€3,278	€3,377	€2,803	€2,213	€1,605	€979	€334
Grant Repayment (Year 5+)						€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€22,479	€11,467
Loan	€20,000	€21,000	€21,920	€22,757	€23,507	€24,164	€24,725	€25,184	€25,537	€25,778	€25,901
Loan Interes	5%	€1,000	€920	€837	€749	€657	€561	€459	€353	€241	€123
Loan Repayment		€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590	€2,590
Sales Revenue		€37,500	€47,625	€60,484	€76,814	€97,554	€123,894	€157,345	€199,828	€253,782	€322,303
Cost of Sales		€6,250	€7,938	€10,081	€12,802	€16,259	€20,649	€26,224	€33,305	€42,297	€53,717
Gross Profit		€31,250	€39,688	€50,403	€64,012	€81,295	€103,245	€131,121	€166,524	€211,485	€268,586
Overall Operation Expenses		€95,873	€53,298	€59,298	€57,248	€96,957	€96,957	€94,907	€94,907	€123,907	€112,895
Net Profit Before Tax		-€64,623	-€13,611	-€8,895	€6,764	-€15,662	€6,288	€36,214	€71,617	€87,578	€155,691
Tax	12.5%	-€8,078	-€1,701	-€1,112	€845	-€1,958	€786	€4,527	€8,952	€10,947	€19,461
Cash Flow (Net Profit After Tax)		-€56,545	-€11,909	-€7,783	€5,918	-€13,704	€5,502	€31,687	€62,665	€78,631	€136,229
Discount Rate	9%										
DCF Factor		0.9174	0.8417	0.7722	0.7084	0.6499	0.5963	0.5470	0.5019	0.4604	0.4224
NPV		-€51,878	-€10,024	-€6,010	€4,193	-€8,907	€3,281	€17,334	€31,449	€35,283	€57,545
Cumulative NPV		-€51,878	-€61,900	-€67,910	-€63,717	-€72,624	-€69,344	-€52,010	-€20,560	€14,723	€72,267

12.5 Financial Trends and forecasts


Revenue vs Expenses
Sales Revenue
Overall Operation Expenses
€200,000
€180,000
€160,000
€140,000
€120,000
€100,000
€80,000
€60,000
€40,000
€20,000
€0
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2
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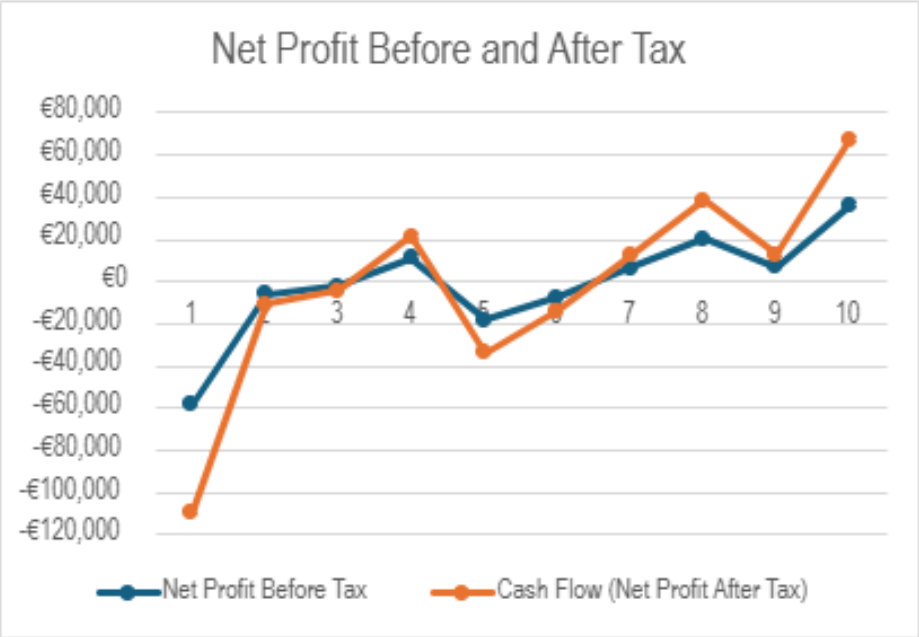
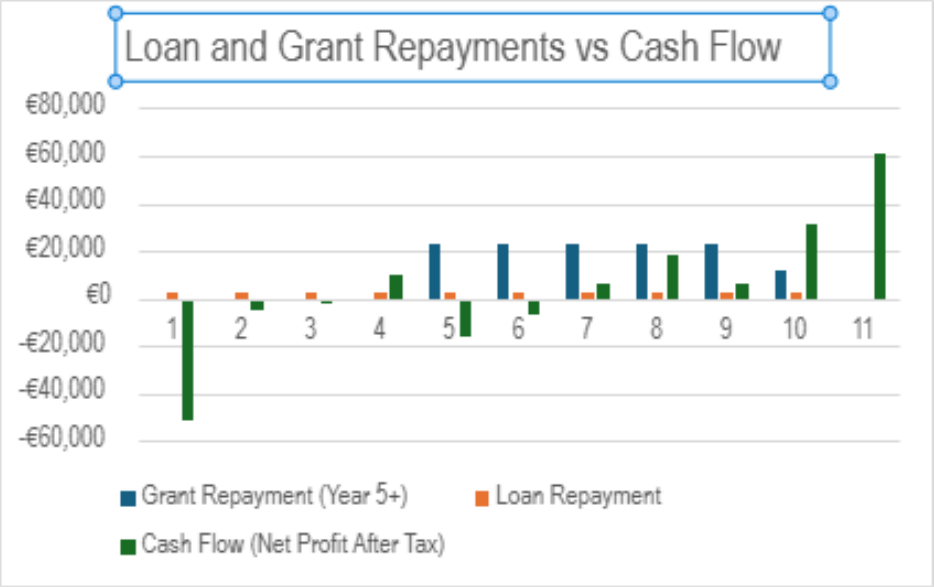
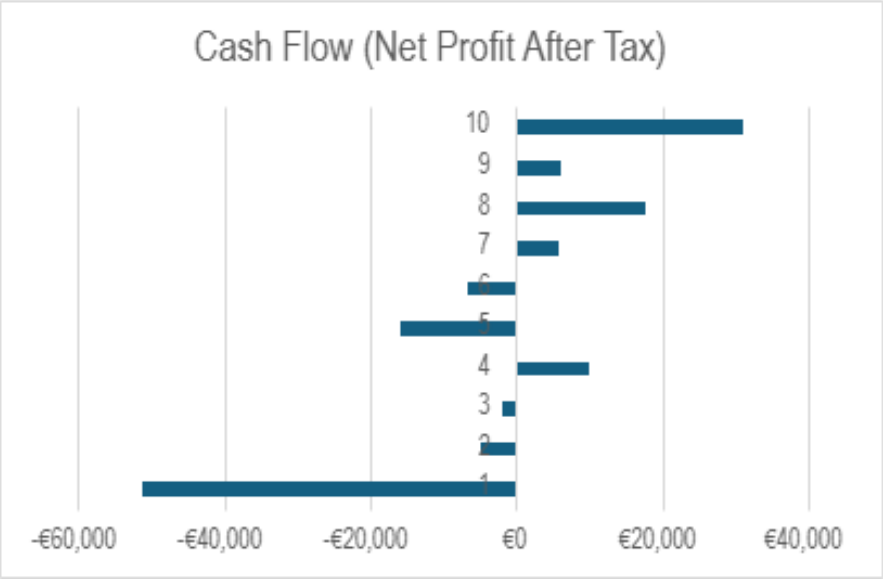
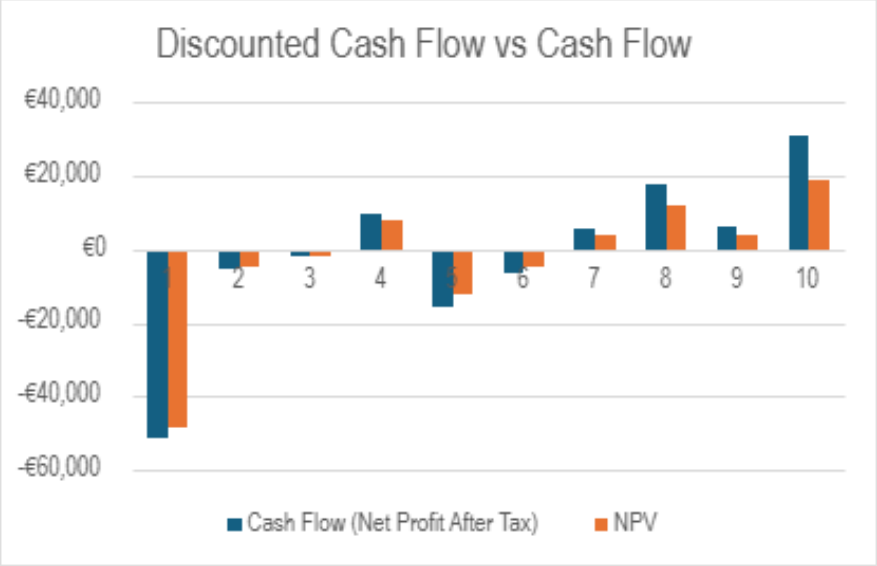
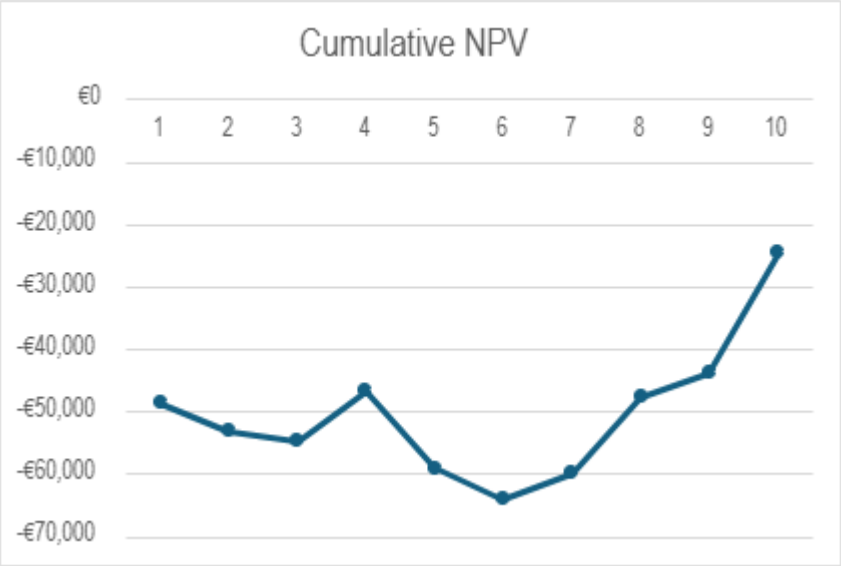
7
8
9
10

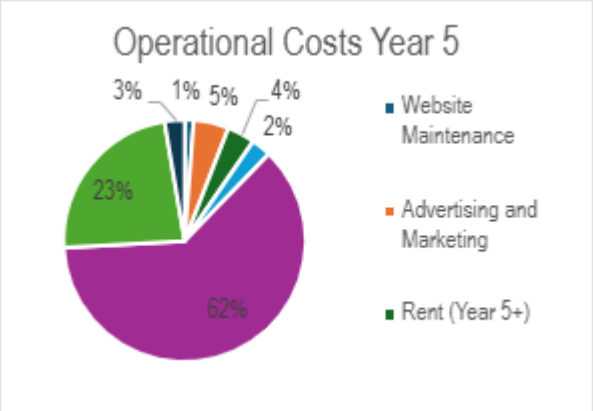

Net Profit Before and After Tax
€80,000
€60,000
€40,000
€20,000
€0
-€20,000
-€40,000
-€60,000
-€80,000
-€100,000
-€120,000
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
Net Profit Before Tax
Cash Flow (Net Profit After Tax)


Loan and Grant Repayments vs Cash Flow
€80,000
€60,000
€40,000
€20,000
€0
-€20,000
-€40,000
-€60,000
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
Grant Repayment (Year 5+)
Loan Repayment
Cash Flow (Net Profit After Tax)


Cash Flow (Net Profit After Tax)
10
9
8
7
4
3
-€60,000
-€40,000
-€20,000
€0
€20,000
€40,000


Discounted Cash Flow vs Cash Flow
€40,000
€20,000
€0
-€20,000
-€40,000
-€60,000
2
3
4
6
7
8
9
10
Cash Flow (Net Profit After Tax)
NPV


Cumulative NPV
€0
-€10,000
-€20,000
-€30,000
-€40,000
-€50,000
-€60,000
-€70,000
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10



12.6 Workings

Our financial plan outlines the expected costs, revenue, and profitability of Disdain over the coming years. As a product-based business, we anticipate initial setup and manufacturing costs in the early stages. However, by maintaining a competitive pricing strategy and controlling operational expenses, we aim to achieve steady growth and reach profitability within the first few years.

PRICE ESTIMATE

Our pricing strategy is based on positioning our product as a more affordable alternative to competitors, with a retail price of €2.31. This price is determined by the recipe and manufacturing costs.

LABEL COSTS

- Initial charge: €280
- After the first year: €650
- After ten years: €250

PREMISES AND UTILITIES

As Disdain grows, we plan to begin renting a warehouse in Year 5.

- Rent: €2,000 per month (€24,000 per year)
- Utilities (electricity and water): €583 per month (€7,000 per year)

SALARIES

Beginning in Year 2, we will allocate €120,000 to stakeholders' salaries. This amount will increase every two years.

ENTERPRISE IRELAND GRANT

We have secured a maximum grant of €25,000 from Enterprise Ireland. This funding will provide essential capital to start the business.

INITIAL STOCK INVESTMENT

Components	Price
Ingredients	€ 294.30
Cans	€ 45
Packaging	€ 15
Distribution	€ 30
Lids	€ 300
TOTAL	€ 684

In our first year, we plan to produce 300 units of our product.

Breakdown:

- Manufacturing cost: 300 × 684

WEBSITE EXPENSES

Website maintenance will cost €2,500 annually. This includes hosting, storage, and developer fees.

COST OF SALES

- Year 1: 300 units sold × €30 = €9,000

SALES REVENUE

- Year 1: 300 units sold × €50 = €15,000

13. RESOURCES

DISDAIN will require a focused range of resources to support its launch as an honest, cola-flavoured energy drink under LMB Consultants. We will keep costs controlled and steady by relying on strict branding, planning, and communication, while making use of external specialists for production, food safety, and design where required.

13.1 Production Resources

The main resources required for production include approved ingredients, aluminum cans, lids, packaging materials, and access to a licensed distributor. Production will be outsourced to Bev Craft, allowing DISDAIN to avoid the high cost of buying machinery or running our own production factory while retaining control of product identity, branding, and pricing.

The product is based on a cola-flavoured energy drink with a primary ingredient list containing:

- Carbonated Water
- Caffeine from Guarna Plant extract
- Ginseng
- Vitamins (B6, B12G, C, D, and Magnesium)
- Ginger Extract
- Natural Cola Flavouring
- Sugar
- Taurine

Our current working figures for a 100,000 can batch (subject to change) -

Resource	Estimated Cost
Ingredients	€9,081
Cans	€15,000
Lids	€3,000
Labour	€15,000
Packaging	€5,000
Distribution	€10,000
Total Estimated Cost	**€57,810**
Estimated Cost Per Can	**58c**

13.2 Storage and Sales Resources

DISDAIN will need a small storage space for finished stock before distribution. This space will be used to keep stock organised, protected, and managed.

Sales resources will include packaging, transport costs, and retailer stock records. These will support sales through local shops, vending machines, student focused areas, and potential online platform sales.
The current business model is based on a price of €2.50 - €2.75 per can, not including any refundable deposit. Based on current estimated cost of €0.58 per can, this indicates a gross return of approximately €1.92-2.17 per can, excluding wider business and marketing costs.
For a 100,000-can batch, this would lead to an estimated sales revenue of €250,000- €275,000. After an estimated batch cost of €57,810, the estimated gross return would be approximately €192,010- €217,010.

13.3 People and Support Resources

The founders — Benjamin Mills, Michael Doherty, and Liam Moore — will be the main internal resource during this initial stage. We will manage product decisions, branding, supplier contact, retailer communication, marketing, and general planning. As stated in the plan, the founders will not take a salary during the first year, allowing money to be reinvested into the business.

External support will be used where specialist knowledge is needed. This may include food safety advice, label checking, accounting, graphic design, web development, and marketing support. These resources will help DISDAIN operate professionally while keeping fixed costs low.

14. RISK ASSESSMENT

The Risk Assessment section identifies potential risks that may affect the launch, growth, and long-term success of DISDAIN Ltd. As a new company entering the energy drink market, our focus is on maintaining quality and growth as we must manage risks connected to regulation, production, competition, finance, and brand awareness. Understanding these risks is crucial to developing suitable mitigation strategies.

14.1 Primary Risks

Regulatory and Labelling

As DISDAIN is a caffeinated carbonated beverage, we must continue to follow Irish and EU food safety and labelling rules. Our brand is built around transparency, so incorrect labels, unclear ingredient information, or misleading claims would directly damage customer trust. If regulations change, or if our packaging does not meet the correct requirements, it could lead to delays and extra costs. To reduce this risk, we will adopt a continuous reviewing process over our labels, nutritional information, and presented claims.

Market Saturation and Competition

The energy drink market is already crowded, with major established brands ******* already holding strong positions. These companies have strong customer trust and existing retail and marketing relationships. This holds potential difficulty for Disdain to stand out as we expand our business and distribution avenues. Our response is to focus on untapped gaps, our honest branding, simple ingredients, and affordable prices.

Production and Third-Party Dependency

Our manufacturing is outsourced to Bev Craft, which helps us avoid the cost of owning machinery or running our own production facility. However, it also means we depend on a third party for production timing, quality control, capacity, and pricing. If production is delayed or costs increase, our stock levels and retailer relationships could be affected. We will manage this risk by keeping clear communication with our manufacturer, planning production runs early and looking at backup suppliers or production options where possible.

Quality and Consistency

Our product depends on customers receiving the same taste, caffeine effect, carbonation, and quality every time they buy it. If one batch tastes different or has quality issues, it could reduce repeat purchases and harm the brand. This is especially important because our sales strategy depends on trust, feedback, and long-term customer loyalty. We will reduce this risk through batch checks, taste testing, supplier records, and regular quality reviews.

Stock and Distribution

As DISDAIN is primarily sold through local outlets and vending machines, poor stock control could lead to empty shelves, missed sales, or too much unsold stock. This risk may increase as we move into more shops, college areas, and eventually larger retailers. We will keep distribution controlled by monitoring sales, reviewing stock levels regularly, and expanding only when demand is strong enough.

Pricing and Costs

DISDAIN has ongoing costs for production, packaging, storage, delivery, marketing, website development, promotion, and retailer margins. If these costs rise faster than sales, or if our price does not cover them properly, cash flow and profit margins could come under pressure. At the same time, our product must stay affordable, so customers do not choose cheaper or more established competitors. We will manage this risk by tracking costs closely, confirming supplier prices before production, and reviewing our pricing against real costs.

Health Perception

Energy drinks can receive criticism due to the levels of caffeine and sugar present, along with the attached health concerns, especially when aimed towards a younger market. This can affect how our product is viewed by potential customers, especially with our primary market being that of students and young adults. We will work to reduce this risk by being transparent about what is present in the drink, avoiding misleading claims, and responsible promotion. Our goal is to champion honesty with our brand in this market.

Packaging and Recycling

Our plan includes strong can design, and a coupon system for recycling. This supports our brand image but may also lead to risks if packaging costs rise, recycling rules change, or changes in the gain of the system. We will keep our proposed coupon system simple and engaging, follow packaging requirements, and reduce waste where possible.

14.2 Mitigation Strategies

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Regulatory and Labelling	• Continuously review labels, nutritional information, caffeine content, and product claims • Ensure packaging follows Irish and EU food safety and labelling requirements • Avoid unclear or misleading wording in marketing and packaging
Market Saturation and Competition	• Promote our affordable price, simple ingredients, and transparency • Build stronger links with students, gamers, and young adults • Use local promotion, sampling, and social media to grow awareness
Production	• Maintain clear communication with Bev Craft • Plan production runs early to avoid stock shortages
Quality and Consistency	• Keep supplier and production records • Review customer feedback to identify any issues quickly • Maintain the same recipe, flavour, caffeine effect, and can quality across batches
Stock and Distribution	• Restock based on sales patterns and demand • Avoid expanding into too many locations before supply is reliable • Review distribution performance as we move into more shops and college areas
Pricing and Costs	• Keep the product affordable while protecting profit margins

	• Track production, packaging, storage, delivery, marketing, and retailer costs closely
Health Perception	• Clearly show ingredients, caffeine information, and nutritional details • Promote responsible consumption • Keep our message honest and transparent
Packaging and Recycling	• Follow packaging and recycling requirements • Monitor packaging costs and adjust where needed • Reduce unnecessary waste while keeping the can design strong and appealing

15. LETTER OF SUPPORT

Riverside Convenience Store
12 Barrett Street, Athlone, Co. Westmeath
090-3141592

AIB
1 Custom Place,
Athlone,
Co. Westmeath

March 15th, 2026

To whom it may concern,

I am writing to offer my support for DISDAIN Ltd in their application for a loan. As the manager of a local independent convenience store, I can see a clear market for an affordable energy drink with transparent labelling and responsible promotion.

Having reviewed their sample product and spoken with the team, I believe they are dedicated, knowledgeable, and well-positioned to succeed. Their local distribution plan through shops and vending machines is realistic for reaching students and young workers.

I am confident that DISDAIN can make a positive contribution to the Irish soft drinks market and that your funding will be well-placed. Provided the final product is produced and labelled in line with Irish and EU food safety requirements, I would be willing to stock and promote the product.

Please feel free to contact me on 090-3141592 or Terry.donnell@riversideconvenience.ie if you require any further information or clarification.

Kind Regards,

Terry O'Donnell

Manager, Riverside Convenience Store

16. FOOD SAFETY DECLARATION

Business Operator:	DISDAIN Ltd.
Address:	Terry Rd Athlone, Westmeath, Ireland
Product Name:	DISDAIN Energy
Product Type:	Caffeinated Carbonated Beverage
Product Designation:	355ml energy drink

The designated product is intended to be produced and labelled in conformity with the following food safety and information requirements.

Regulation (EC) No 178/2002 and amendments	General Food Law: establishes food-safety responsibilities and requires that unsafe food is not placed on the market.
Regulation (EC) No 852/2004 and amendments	General Food Law: establishes food-safety responsibilities and requires that unsafe food is not placed on the market.
Regulation (EC) No 1169/2001 *and amendments*	Food Information to Consumers: requires clear, accurate, non-misleading labels, including ingredient, allergen, nutrition, net quantity, English-language information, and high-caffeine warnings where required.
Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 *and amendments*	Food Additives: controls authorised additives and their conditions of use in food and drinks.
Regulation (EC) No 1924/2006 *and amendments*	Nutrition and Health Claims: controls any claims used on product labels, websites, or advertising, and helps prevent misleading promotion.

Food Safety System:	HACCP-based food safety management plan, supplier traceability, batch records, and recall procedure
Food Safety Review Date:	3rd March 2026
Place of Signature:	Dublin Food Safety Consultancy Ltd
Signature:	Jack Murphy
Name:	Jack Murphy, Food Safety Consultant, Dublin Food Safety Consultancy Ltd

This food safety and labelling declaration is issued under the sole responsibility of the company. It confirms intended compliance with the requirements indicated above but is not a warranty or official approval. Sugar Sweetened Drinks Tax obligations should be reviewed separately.

15. REFERENCES

Market Data Forecast (2024). Europe Soft Drinks Market Report. Available at: https://www.marketdataforecast.com [Accessed 30 Apr 2026].

Euromonitor (2024). Energy Drinks in Ireland Report. Available at: https://www.euromonitor.com [Accessed 30 Apr 2026].

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NielsenIQ (2024). Consumer Trends: Increasing Concern About Ingredients and Health. Available at: https://nielseniq.com [Accessed 30 Apr 2026].

Citizens Information Ireland (2023). *Starting a business in Ireland*. Available at: https://www.citizensinformation.ie

Bevcraft (2026). Beverage Manufacturing Services Ireland. Available at: https://www.bevcraft.ie [Accessed 30 Apr 2026].

Cvs are included within the project folder